

robots had started to gain a foothold in the industry and there were more than 3,000 industrial robots in operation around the globe. Currently, there are more than 1.3 million robots being used in various industries and the number is going to keep on rising.

Types of robots

According to the International Federation of Robotics, robots today can be categorised into two categories – service robots and industrial robots. Industrial robots have revolutionised the production world, increasing the efficiency and reducing manual labour significantly. This \$9.5 billion dollar industry is only going to grow.

Service robots, a relatively new field, have also seen major advances in the past few decades, slowly integrating into our daily lives. The adoption has been so seamless that we don't even realise we are surrounded by robots everywhere. There are robots that help researchers explore the seabed, robots like the Mars Rover that not only traverses an unknown terrain on an alien planet but collects data samples from its surroundings and processes it as well.

The robots can be broadly categorised into the following segments:

- **Factory robots** – A breed of industrial robots that help design, manufacture and package things. Almost the entire manufacturing industry is automated right now and everything from cars to aeroplanes to safety pins, are manufactured using robots.



Credit: YouTube / FANUC